Anja Van Staden

UI/UX DESIGN | PRODUCT DESIGN | FRONTEND DEVELOPMENT

Stellenbosch, South Africa | Open to Relocation
Dutch & South African Citizen | EU Work Authorisation – No Visa or Sponsorship Required
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My Portfolio: https://anjavanstaden.vercel.app/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year BSc Computer Science & Operations Research student with a strong interest in UI/UX, product design and frontend development. Combines solid software development fundamentals with a creative, user-focused approach to designing and building intuitive digital experiences. Hands-on experience across React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS and Figma, supported by university projects spanning frontend, full-stack and software development. Brings strong analytical and problem-solving skills, an eye for clean design and the ability to translate complex requirements into practical, user-friendly solutions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- UI/UX Design
- Product Design
- Frontend Development
- Web Development
- User-Centred Design
- Responsive Design
- Prototyping
- Full-Stack Development
- Software Development
- Problem Solving
- Business Analytics
- Agile Collaboration

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design & Prototyping: Figma | Canva
Frontend & Web: JavaScript | HTML | CSS | ReactJS | ExpressJS
Programming: Java | JavaFX | C | Python | MATLAB | R | x86 Assembly
Databases: SQL | MySQL
Modelling & Optimisation: LINGO | AnyLogic
Tools & DevOps: Linux (Bash/CLI) | Git | GitHub | GitLab | Docker | CI/CD Pipelines
AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code | Cursor
Project & Collaboration: Scrum | Jira | Confluence | Microsoft Office

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science & Operations Research | Stellenbosch University, South Africa
Expected Graduation: November 2026
Current Average: 77.5% | German-equivalent Grade: 2.3

National Senior Certificate | Point High School, Mossel Bay, South Africa | 2021
Average: 88.14% | German-equivalent Grade: 1.7

SELECTED PROJECTS

Honours Lab Management Application
React | *Frontend Development* | *UI Design*

- Developed a React single-page application to support university lab logistics and improve the user experience
- Designed an interactive 7 × 10 seat reservation interface displaying live occupancy and availability
- Built user login, editable profile and Q&A functionality, an announcement feed and navigation between application sections
- Implemented persistent state using localStorage, tag filtering and individual user theming within a clean, intuitive interface focused on ease of use

Community Event & Volunteer Platform | Entelect Industry Project
Full-Stack Development | *Team Collaboration*

- Collaborated within a six-person team to design and develop a full-stack web platform for community organisations
- Built functionality enabling organisations to create and manage events, recruit and coordinate volunteers, and track attendance and volunteer hours
- Contributed to both the technical development and overall usability of the platform while working within a collaborative project environment

Peer-to-Peer File Sharing Application
Java | *JavaFX* | *Networking*

- Developed an anonymous peer-to-peer file-sharing application in Java using a lightweight coordination server
- Enabled direct client-to-client file transfers and cross-network communication using Tailscale VPN
- Created a JavaFX graphical user interface incorporating live animations to provide a more engaging and intuitive user experience

Parallel Othello Player with Monte Carlo Tree Search (MCTS)
C | *MPI* | *Parallel Computing*

- Developed a high-performance Othello AI in C using Monte Carlo Tree Search for intelligent move selection
- Parallelised processing using MPI across multiple cores to improve playing strength within a fixed time constraint
- Applied algorithmic problem-solving, performance optimisation and parallel computing principles to a complex software challenge

Additional Technical Projects: Multicore Process Scheduler Simulation in C, covering process lifecycle management, scheduling and deadlock detection; and Compiler Design in C, involving lexical, syntactic and semantic analysis and JVM bytecode generation

PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE

Data Structures & Algorithms Learning Assistant
Stellenbosch University | February 2026 – June 2026

- Supported students in understanding and applying key data structures and algorithms concepts
- Assisted with problem-solving and explained complex programming concepts in a clear, accessible way
- Helped students work through technical challenges and develop stronger programming and analytical skills

Hospitality & Wine Service Assistant
Jakkalsvlei Wines, Herbertsdale | January 2019 – December 2021

- Assisted with hospitality and wine service within a busy customer-facing environment
- Provided friendly and professional service while responding to guest requirements
- Worked effectively as part of a team to support smooth day-to-day operations

LANGUAGES

English | Native / Full Professional Proficiency
Afrikaans | Native / Full Professional Proficiency
German | Actively Developing
Dutch | Passive Proficiency

REFERENCES AVAILABLE ON REQUEST